



Mahindra Satyam joins Symbian Foundation

Mahindra Satyam, part of the \$6.3 billion Mahindra Group, has joined the Symbian Foundation, which, together with others in its ecosystem, is creating an open and complete mobile software platform.

The platform is based on Symbian OS and software assets contributed by Nokia, NTT DoCoMo, and Sony Ericsson, including the S60 and MOAP(S) user interfaces. Portions of the source code are already being moved to open source, under the Eclipse Public License. By mid-2010, this process will be complete. As a member of the Symbian Foundation, Mahindra Satyam gains the immediate right to licence the Symbian Foundation platform, royalty-free and without source code fees; participate in the governance of the foundation; and take part in joint marketing and branding campaigns.

Another Linux-based mobile OS from Samsung

It seems like established Linux-based mobile OSs, Android and LiMo weren't enough. Samsung has announced its plans to come out with its own offering, dubbed bada, in December. The name bada, which means ocean in Korean, was chosen to convey the limitless variety of potential applications that can be created using the new platform, the media release states.

Samsung expects the first handsets to be launched in the first half of 2010. Keep yourself updated at www.bada.com.

SixthSense to go open source!

Pranav Mistry, a 28-year-old research assistant at the Massachusetts Institute of Technology's Media Lab, on November 8 demonstrated the latest version of SixthSense at the TEDIndia conference, in Mysore. Mistry is the genius behind SixthSense, a wearable gestural interface that augments the physical world around us with digital information and lets us use natural hand gestures to interact with



that information. Mistry now plans to open source his project in less than a month.

The SixthSense prototype comprises a pocket projector, mirror and camera worn in a pendant-like mobile device. Both the projector and the camera are connected to a mobile computing device in the user's pocket. The system projects information onto the surfaces and physical objects around us, making any surface into a

digital interface; the camera recognises and tracks both the user's hand gestures and physical objects using computer-vision-based techniques.

SixthSense uses simple computer-vision techniques to process the video-stream data captured by the camera and follows the locations of coloured markers on the user's fingertips (which are used for visual tracking). In addition, the software interprets the data into gestures to use for interacting with the projected application interfaces. SixthSense also supports multi-touch and multi-user interaction. The current prototype system costs approximately \$350 (around Rs 15,000) to build.

Nokia finally starts shipping N900

The highly anticipated Maemo Linux-based N900 smartphone has officially started shipping. The Nokia N900, which has generated a lot of interest since its public launch in August, runs on an ARM Cortex-A8-based OMAP3430 system-on-chip with 1 GB of memory and 32 GB Flash memory. It offers 3G HSPA data and voice, and includes a 3.5-inch (8.9 cm), 800 x 400 touch screen and a 5 mega-pixel camera. It has a QWERTY keyboard, plus Wi-Fi, GPS, Bluetooth and accelerometers. The feature-packed N900 is going to find its place among the latest high-end smartphones. Its competitors are iPhone, Samsung's LiMo-based Vodafone 360 H1 and Motorola's much-touted Android-based Droid.



First Android phone from Sony Ericsson

Sony Ericsson has launched its first ever Android-based handset. The XPERIA X10 introduces a new UX platform that will evolve across the product portfolio and expand over time, continuously introducing new features and capabilities. The UX platform builds on top of Android and combines entertainment features with signature applications, integration of social media services and a graphical user interface. The X10, which will be available in Q1 2010, features a 4-inch-wide (10.1 cm) touch screen, uses Qualcomm's Snapdragon processor, and comes with an 8.1 mega-pixel camera.

Introducing signature applications like Mediascape and Timescape, the XPERIA X10 lets users organise everything on their phone in an intuitive way. Sony Ericsson Timescape manages all your communications with one person, in one place. Browse through your conversations on Facebook, Twitter, photos, e-mails and texts, all in one go. Sony Ericsson Mediascape claims to be the smart way to get all the music, photos and videos you want from your favourite friends and artists.